ACHIEVEMENT AND PERFORMANCE

Charitable activities

During the year, the charity has undertaken the following activities:

1. Provided financial and organisational support to the Regional Airborne Forces Days across the Country.

2. Attended funerals and memorial services of former serving members of The Parachute Regiment and Airborne Forces.

3. Actively fundraised for other Regimental Charities i.e. The Parachute Regiment Charity and The Airborne Forces Security Fund.

4. Provided funds and organisational support to the Regimental Memorial Day at Parachute Regiment and Airborne Forces Memorial at the National Memorial Arboretum.

5. Made donations in support of the maintenance of Regimental Memorials.

6. Provided grants in support of and organisational support to:

- 72nd Anniversary of the Rhine Crossing Biennial Commemoration service.
- 73rd Anniversary 'D Day' Commemoration events in Normandy and Arnhem.
- Recruit Platoon passing out parades at ITC Catterick.
- Support to Airborne 'In Pensioners' at the Royal Hospital Chelsea.
- The Parachute Regimental Association Executive Committee Biannual meeting.
- The Parachute Regimental Association Annual General Meeting.
- The Parachute Regiment Memorial day.
- Airborne Forces Memorial Parades at Glasgow, Bedworth, Hardwick Hall, Aldershot, Eden Camp, Portsmouth and Colchester.
- Memorial Parades and Services at St Pauls Cathedral and St Lawrence Jewry.
- RBL Field of Remembrance Services at Westminster Abbey.
- The Annual Armistice Parade in Whitehall, London.

FINANCIAL REVIEW

Financial position

The result for the year shows a deficit (net expenditure) of £7,959 compared to a surplus (net income) of £28,773 in 2016, the main cause of this is due to an increase in grant expenditure and a reduction in investment income.

Income for the year totalled £119,092 (2016: £105,742), this was an increase to the previous year. Notably the investment income decreased by £6k but the three regional branches income has increased by £20,521 from 2016. Donated services and facilities from the Ministry of Defence (MOD) increased in 2017 to £52,077 (2016 £45,319), this was as a result of the PRA Secretary's post being vacant for a period of time in the previous year. This donated services figure represents free office accommodation and the provision of employee services to the charity (the related costs are shown within the wages expenditure line on the detailed SOFA).

Total resources expended in the year amounted to £144,760 compared to £116,843 in 2016, an increase of £27,917. The majority of the increase was in respect of the increase in wages and the increase in the three regional branches, which is in line with the increase in regional income mentioned above. Expenditure on most other areas remained relatively constant.

FINANCIAL REVIEW

Investment policy and objectives

At the year end the charity held investments, with a market value of £731,931 (2016: £635,000), in the Schroders Income Trust for Charities units and JM Finn from 1 July 2107.

The Trustees have the power to invest in such assets as they feel appropriate and meet both the requirements of the charity in the short and long-term and are also risk appropriate to the charity. The Trustees regularly review the performance of its investments in line with the charity's current and future plans.

Reserves policy

As at 31 December 2017 the charity's total reserves were £797,615 (2016: £805,574), all of which were unrestricted for the charity to use in meeting its charitable objectives. The Trustees have reviewed their current level of reserves which equate to just over 5 times the charity's annual expenditure, this ratio has remained relatively constant over the last few years, and has been mostly dependent on the fluctuations in investment performance. The Trustees consider their level of reserves to be reasonable having reviewed the economic climate and risks to the charity's income.

STRUCTURE, GOVERNANCE AND MANAGEMENT

Governing document

The charity is controlled by its governing document, a deed of trust, and constitutes an unincorporated charity.

Constitution dated 20 June 1964, as amended 8 July 1972, 3 July 1978, 9 May 1993, 31 October 1999, 13 May 2000, 8 July 2001, 8 October 2005, 26 January 2008, 12 October 2008, 18 July 2009, 6 July 2013, 27 November 2014 and 8 July 2017.

Organisational structure

The Trustees who have served during the year and since the year end are set out on page 1.

The Chairman of the Committee of Management is a serving officer nominated by the Parachute Regiment; presently this is the Regimental Lieutenant Colonel.

Further members of the Committee of Management comprise of one representative of the following regions: Anglia, London, Midlands, North, North East, North West, South, South East, South West, Wales, and Yorkshire. These representatives are elected by branches of their own region and hold office for three years.

The Association structure comprises of:

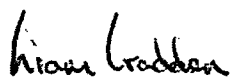
a) The central Association charity (registered number 214015): In support of its charitable activities the central charity offers individual membership to eligible individuals and provides central and regional support for local branches.

b) 77 local branches which exist to further the purposes of the Association and are separately registered with their respective charity regulator. (PRA members may additionally become members of one or more local branches.) The elected members of the committee of management of the central Association charity also act as Regional Secretaries and provide regional support during the course of the year to branches in their respective region.

Related parties

The Parachute Regimental Association is one of a number of charities connected with the Parachute Regiment and Airborne Forces, but these are not considered to be related parties under FRS 102. A summary of any related parties and transactions with them is set out in note 12 to the financial statements.

Approved by order of the board of trustees on 28 April 2018 and signed on its behalf by:



Lt Col L Cradden MBE - Trustee